

227 Lay a stick trail

20
MINS

Tracking is a great skill, and it's easy if you use stick symbols. Grab some friends and head for a nearby park or woodland. Lay a stick trail and see if your friends can find you.



What you need

- Sticks
- 2 watches
- A group of friends
- Let parents know where you're going

1 Agree on your symbols (see the activity below for ideas). Split into two teams—trailblazers and trackers. Be sure each member is with at least one other person and that each team has a watch.

2 Trailblazers should run ahead and lay the trail, using plenty of arrows, especially where the route is overgrown or several paths meet. They should then lie in wait for the trackers.

3 After 10 minutes, it's time for the trackers to set off after the trailblazers. Time how long it takes for them to find where the trailblazers are hidden.



Stick symbol

4 Once the the trailblazers have been found, swap roles and start again to see who's the best at each skill.

228 Memorize some trail symbols

3
MINS

You can make up your own codes, but here are three common ones. An X means “not this way.” A straight arrow means “go straight ahead.” A dot in a circle means “gone home.”

